INDIA TODAY S2 STATE OF THE STATES MADHYA PRADESH FIRST

▶ KEYNOTE ADDRESS: CONNECTING MADHYA PRADESH TO THE WORLD

Jyotiraditya Scindia,
Union Minister of Civil Aviation and Steel



"Movement of aircraft has grown 242% since July 2021"

On his vision of Madhya Pradesh
The potential of Madhya Pradesh in various fields is infinite. Each region offers something, be it the tourism potential in Gwalior-Chambal and Bundelkhand, the mineral wealth of Baghelkhand and Mahakoshal or the agricultural and industrial potential of Malwa.

On what he wants done in MP in the next two-to-three years
Two-to-three years is too short a window to look at ideation, execution and the benefits of it percolating down. In the last one year, the push I have given in the civil aviation sector in Madhya Pradesh has started bearing fruit.

On the growth potential in the civil aviation sector
In 2019-20, just before Covid, the Railways was ferrying 185 million passengers in AC I and AC II tier coaches. Around the same time, 145 million passengers were travelling by air... I mention AC I and AC II tier passengers because they compare with air travellers. In the same AC I and AC II tier categories, the CAGR recorded was 5.3 per cent while the CAGR in the civil aviation sector was 10.5 per cent.

On what is being done to connect MP to other destinations
Since July 2021, the total aircraft movement in Madhya Pradesh has increased from 1,296 to 4,442 presently, a growth of 242 per cent. Bhopal, which was connected to five destinations back then, is now connected to 13. The commercial capital was connected to eight destinations then and is now connected to 19. Besides this, Indore also has an international flight to Dubai. Gwalior and Jabalpur were connected to five cities and are now connected to nine destinations, suggesting that most major cities in MP have seen an increase in connectivity by 200-300 per cent. On the infrastructure front, new airports are being built in Gwalior and Rewa, while the Indore and Bhopal airports will have cargo terminals. The Jabalpur airport is being upgraded with a new runway, ATC tower and integrated terminal. CM Shivraj Singh Chouhan has also reduced VAT on ATF (air turbine fuel in MP from 25 to 21 per cent, facilitating more flights. ■



(Above) 1. **Vikram Singh Ahakey**, *Mayor, Chhindwara*

▲ HOT TOPIC: BEING YOUNG IN MADHYA PRADESH—WHAT DO THE YOUTH WANT?

▼ IN FOCUS: BATTING FOR GLORY—HOW MADHYA PRADESH BECAME RANJI CHAMPIONS

